

Rouzhi Liang

(469) 323-4731 · rouzhi@smu.edu

3300 Dyer Street, Dallas, TX 75275

Latest version available [here](#)

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Southern Methodist University	<i>Expected 2026</i>
M.S. in Economics, University of Wisconsin-Madison	<i>2018</i>
B.A. in Economics, Beihang University	<i>2016</i>

Research Interests

Macroeconomics and Growth, Family Economics, Culture, Entrepreneurship

Working Papers

Bequests, Fertility, and Barriers to Entrepreneurship (*Job Market Paper*) ([PDF](#))

This paper studies how parental fertility and bequest decisions influence children's ability to become entrepreneurs in the presence of financial frictions.

Individualism and Innovation: Unraveling Culture's Influence Across Time ([PDF](#))

This paper examines the impact of individualism on innovation and economic development over time, both cross-country and within the US.

Research in Progress

Finance, Demographic Transition, and Structural Change

Multiple Entrepreneurial Talent Misallocation with [Javier Gonzalez](#)

Research Experience

Graduate Research Assistant for Dr. Wookun Kim	<i>2020</i>
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- Processed and analyzed NASA satellite-based pollution data using Python and QGIS

Graduate Research Assistant for Dr. Michael Sposi	<i>2022</i>
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- Collected and cleaned world import and export data
- Used Stata to compute descriptive statistics

Graduate Research Assistant for Dr. Daniel L. Millimet	<i>2024</i>
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- Collected and cleaned Census data
- Constructed and replicated county-level trade shock data

Teaching Experience

Instructor: Intermediate Macroeconomics (SMU, Summer 2023)

Teaching Assistant:

Ph.D.-level: Macroeconomic Theory I; Microeconomic Theory I & II

Master-level: Strategic Behavior; Economic Analysis I & II

Undergraduate-level: International Macroeconomic Theory and Policy; Price Theory

Conference and Seminar Presentations

Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting	2024
<i>Bequests, Fertility, and Barriers to Entrepreneurship</i> (Graduate Student Award)	
Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting	2023
<i>Individualism and Innovation: Unraveling Culture's Influence Across Time</i>	
SMU Research and Innovation Week	2023
<i>Bequests, Fertility, and Barriers to Entrepreneurship</i>	

Skills

Programming	Python, Stata, QGIS, L ^A T _E X
Language	English (Fluent), Mandarin (Native)

Fellowship & Awards

Provost's Doctoral Candidacy Fellowship, Southern Methodist University (2023-Present)
Graduate Fellowship, Southern Methodist University (2019-2023)
Graduate Student Award, 2024 Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting

Leadership & Outreach

SMU Dedman Graduate Student Assembly, Representative for the Economics Department (2023-2025)
SMU Dedman Graduate Student Assembly, President (2025-2026)
Moody School Graduate Student Advisory Member from Dedman College (2025-2026)

References

Dr. Ömer Özak (Advisor)

Associate Professor of Economics, Southern Methodist University
Email: ozak@mail.smu.edu

Dr. Klaus Desmet

Ruth and Kenneth Altshuler Centennial Interdisciplinary Professor, Southern Methodist University
Email: kdesmet@mail.smu.edu

Dr. Michael Sposi

Associate Professor and Director of Doctoral Studies, Southern Methodist University
Email: msposi@mail.smu.edu

Dr. Rocío Madera

Assistant Professor of Economics, Southern Methodist University
Email: romadera@smu.edu